



STATUS REPORT

Chad — digital transformation and data governance status report

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ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Chad reaches the rest of the internet through one route, and in February 2026 it was not working: the government was pressing Sotel Tchad and Airtel to fast-track a revised agreement on the [N'Djamena–Mberé link to Cameroon](#) after the regulator ARCEP suspended the underpinning memorandum over clauses it judged contrary to national digital sovereignty — and that link is [the landlocked country's only entry point for international submarine-cable capacity](#). The second corridor, Chad's section of the Trans-Saharan backbone toward Niger, [stood at 32% complete in March 2025](#), and a January 2026 inspection mission [found vandalism and degradation at the Bol technical site in Lac province](#).

Take-up has not moved. [13.2% of the population used the internet in October 2025](#), on 2.79 million users, the same rate as a year earlier. [Mobile connections equal 73.3% of the population](#), but those are active SIMs rather than people: ITU put [unique mobile-phone penetration at 44.3% in 2024](#), and only 8.6% of adults owned a smartphone [that year](#). Coverage runs well ahead of use — [about 60% of the population lay under a 4G network in 2023](#) — and what capacity exists is thin, at [roughly 21 kbit/s of international bandwidth per user in 2022](#). Chad's IIAG Internet & Computers score of [5.5 out of 100 was the fourth worst of that index's 96 indicators in 2023](#).

The state's answer is PMICE, the connectivity modernisation programme [launched in July 2020 with Huawei as contractor](#) and financed by a [111 billion FCFA China Eximbank loan](#). Operators were [ordered under a seven-day ultimatum in September 2025 to connect to the national fibre network](#), and Phase I [reached Sarh in Moyen-Chari in December 2025](#). Starlink runs on [a multiservice ISP licence granted on application without a public tender](#). In June 2026 the government [rejected fuel-supply shortages as an excuse for outages, slow speeds and high tariffs at Airtel and Moov](#), while the World Bank-financed PATN programme [targets roughly 500 localities with no connectivity at all](#).

Data Storage

Chad's National Data Centre is built and not yet open. The building and its operational equipment are complete, [leaving security audit and certification as the last step before inauguration](#) as at February 2026, and ADETIC, the cybersecurity agency ANSICE and the firm TECHSO-GROUP [signed a tripartite agreement on 5 February 2026 to audit and certify it against critical-infrastructure security standards](#). It is a four-storey building in N'Djamena, the

first phase of PMICE, a €175.1m (US\$204.7m) programme whose commencement was announced on 20 December 2025 and which is financed by a concessional Export-Import Bank of China loan of about 111.4 billion FCFA repayable over 20 years at 2% interest. Huawei built it, with GOLF/Gulf Consulting supervising the works. ADETIC's director general describes it as a strategic base for sovereign housing of state data and the minister toured it with a Chinese delegation in January 2025 as a step toward digital sovereignty. Its power supply sits on a grid that reaches barely a tenth of the population.

Until it opens there is almost nothing. The commercial market consists of one small facility, a 374 m², 400 kW modular colocation centre built for Tigo Chad in N'Djamena in 2016, with no higher-tier commercial site identified, and no hyperscale or regional cloud provider runs an availability zone near enough to serve the country, leaving Chadian users on distant regions at latencies above 100ms.

Government has no arrangements of its own to speak of: no cloud platform, no policy governing where government data may be hosted, and nothing published about its hosting as at 2025. Nor does any localisation rule oblige data to be held in the country, so the sovereignty the data centre is framed around rests on a building rather than on law. An Azerbaijani ICT delegation visited ADETIC in February 2026 to discuss data centre collaboration.

Energy

In June 2026 the government rejected fuel-supply shortages as an excuse for network failures and ordered Moov Africa Chad to migrate its transmission sites to solar and wind power — a telecoms instruction that is really an admission about the grid.

Around 12% of Chad's population had access to electricity in 2023, among the lowest rates in the world, and that access is almost entirely urban: 48% of the urban population against under 1% of the rural population in 2023, a gap of some 48 percentage points. Access to Energy is among Chad's ten worst-scoring IIAG indicators at 8.4 out of 100, 50th of 54 in 2023, and the wider Infrastructure sub-category, which bundles transport, energy and communications, is one of the country's three worst at 17.5 out of 100. A connection is not a steady one: the most recent Enterprise Survey round recorded an average of 4.5 outages a month, with 70% of firms affected, figures dating from 2018. Generation is about 5% renewable, the rest oil-fired thermal, on 2021 data.

Policy runs ahead of delivery. Chad has an approved national electrification plan that explicitly provides for decentralised mini-grid and off-grid solutions for productive uses and community facilities, scoring 67 of 100 on RISE's off-grid framework and 44 on its minigrids framework, with the World Bank-financed Energy Access Scale-Up Project (approved 2022, about US\$28.5 million) rolling out mini-grids and standalone solar in secondary cities and rural areas. The water and energy minister travelled to China in January 2026 to advance solar mini-grids for five cities, working with the World Bank and a Chinese supplier. Electricity is the first of the three constraints named against the government's own cashless public finance mandate in January 2026, ahead of uneven internet coverage and digital literacy.

Technical Capacity

Maintenance of Chad's biometric identity platform [remains with its foreign vendor, with no sign of a shift toward in-country technical management](#), and the technical base that would have to take it over is two tech hubs. The digital business ecosystem is [embryonic, with very limited local start-up activity and only two small tech hubs nationally](#) as at 2023, and tertiary ICT teaching is confined to [a small number of computer science programmes at the country's principal public university](#), with minimal research output behind them.

Inside government the position is thinner still. As at 2025 there was [no dedicated digital government institution and no machinery coordinating or auditing government technology across ministries, no digital skills programme for public servants, and neither a civil service human resource management information system nor a payroll system](#) – so the state cannot administer its own wage bill on a recognised system, let alone build the systems it is buying. Public administration is Chad's strongest sub-category within the IIAG's economic opportunity group, but the [effectiveness of the administration itself fell over 2014-2023](#), and that bureaucracy is what every digitisation programme has to run through.

Cybersecurity

Chad now has a legal class of entities of vital digital importance: an ordinance ratified in March 2026 [established the classification and expanded the cybersecurity agency's regulatory, investigative and enforcement powers](#), alongside a [broadened ANSICE mandate reaching beyond cybersecurity into electronic-transaction security, cybercrime, the national information space and the regulation of video-surveillance systems and drones](#). The statutory base underneath it remains [Law No. 009/PR/2015 on cybersecurity and the fight against cybercrime](#), which is also the instrument the country relies on for digital signatures, digital identification and payments.

Capability sits behind the mandate. Chad scored [48.7 out of 100 on the ITU's Global Cybersecurity Index 2024, in the "Establishing" band](#). ANSICE's visible work is episodic rather than systematic: a [videoconference with the United States CISA in January 2025](#) on threat monitoring, engineer capacity and critical-infrastructure protection, and the [February 2026 agreement with ADETIC and TECHSO-GROUP to audit and certify the National Data Centre](#) before it opens. There is [no statutory duty on any data controller to notify breaches or unauthorised access](#), so the agency governs an estate whose incidents nobody is obliged to tell it about.

The institutional lines are drawn oddly. ADETIC, whose remit is digital infrastructure, extended it to [equipping the national police for cybercrime work in a handover on 20 July 2026](#): the agency that builds the state's networks is also outfitting the force that polices what runs over them, with no oversight arrangement described for the dual role. At the other end, the media regulator HAMA stated on 3 August 2026 that offences committed on digital platforms [do not fall within its competence and belong exclusively to the judicial authorities](#) under the Penal Code and the cybercrime law. Telecom oversight gained its own instrumentation when ARCEP [inaugurated real-time monitoring platforms in June 2026](#) covering traffic, spectrum, quality of service and VSAT.

DPI

Data Exchange

Chad's first working data exchange has been assembled inside the public finance chain rather than across the state: the integrated public finance system SIGFiP now interoperates with the Sydonia customs platform and the e-Tax application for consolidated budget execution reporting, and on 1 April 2026 the tax directorate and the treasury and public accounting directorate signed a protocol establishing automated real-time exchange of data on assessments, collections, arrears and payments. Three weeks earlier the Ministry of Finance and the National Agency for Secure Documents signed a protocol allowing secure real-time consultation of the national biometric population register for identity verification, the first connection of its kind to it, and in May 2026 Airtel's SIM registration data was interconnected with the same registry.

None of it rests on a framework. Chad has no government interoperability framework, and none of the operational standards that would accompany one — data quality, service availability, the retirement of legacy systems — is in place (2025), and the 2015 package of digital-economy laws establishes no authority for cross-government data sharing. Back-office systems were built in silos and no transactional digital service faces an end user (2024), while most government offices have neither broadband nor any means of exchanging data and no sub-national body takes part in a data-exchange arrangement (2024). As at 2025 the tax administration's own system exchanged data with no other government system, and no health information system is integrated into a government-wide exchange (2025).

The 2027 budget orientations would put interoperability at the centre of public finance: the tax, customs and Treasury systems are to be interconnected with budget preparation and execution, public accounting and the cadastre, land and identity platforms, and no ministry is to put in place a system incompatible with those already running.

Separately, TCHADIX, the national internet exchange point run by ADETIC, marked its first year of operation in May 2026, holding national traffic off international routes.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Around 8% of Chad's population had been issued the biometric National Identification Number by 2024. The system behind it is SIGPTS, run by the National Agency for Secure Documents (ANATS), launched in 2020 on IDEMIA biometric technology and issuing both the number and the national ID card, operational in the capital and a growing number of provinces rather than nationwide (2026). Its population register module also carries voter registration and, since 2024, refugee identification.

Enrolment does not start at birth. It begins at around age twelve, and the parallel refugee programme at ten, so younger children hold no biometric credential even where a birth has been registered (2023). Nor is the card free: the fee was cut to 5,000 CFA francs in January 2020, waived from December 2022, then reinstated from 3 August 2023, with a half-price rate announced in June 2024 for students and people with disabilities. The refugee pilot run with the refugee commission, UNHCR and the World Bank had issued around 4,000 refugee identification numbers by May 2025 against a phased target of 25,000, in a refugee population above 1.24 million, to close a gap whereby existing refugee documents were not accepted for bank accounts or SIM registration.

What the credential unlocks is broad but shallow. The card is the recognised basis for proving identity and is accepted for government services and banking checks, but it is not the sole mandatory credential for opening a bank account, obtaining healthcare or registering for social assistance (2023). The government intends the register to become the identification layer that public and private bodies connect to instead of keeping their own identity silos, and in May 2026 ANATS and Airtel Chad signed a partnership for mass enrolment and the securing of population data, with the Ministry of Public Security and the National Police present at the signing.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Chad now has three licensed payment institutions — Airtel Money, licensed in 2023, the domestic fintech Konoom in 2025 and Moov Money Tchad in 2026 — and with them a change of supervisor, as oversight of the mass-market mobile-money rails migrates from the telecoms regulator to the regional banking supervisor COBAC, whose licence carries bank-grade capital, solvency, cybersecurity-audit and client-money obligations.

Use remains among the thinnest in the region. Active mobile money use runs at about 13% of the population (2025), against 55% in Cameroon, and BEAC recorded FCFA 526.7 billion of mobile transactions in Chad at end-2024. Bank rails are thinner still, at 9.0 out of 100 on the Ibrahim Index's access to banking measure, 43rd of 54 (2023). What the wallets do carry is transfers, merchant payments and bills — electricity, water, school fees (2024), and Konoom's wallet is reachable by app, web, USSD without internet and WhatsApp (2026).

There is no domestic instant payment system: Chad participates in GIMACPAY, the CEMAC-wide platform launched commercially in July 2020 and owned about 99.2% by the regional central bank BEAC, which also settles it, where transactions inside the zone are treated identically whether domestic or cross-border and settle through BEAC's SYGMA system once a day (2025); its scheme rules are not published (2023). Chad is covered by the CEMAC interoperable QR code standard adopted in April 2026 and routed through GIMACPAY.

The state is pushing hardest on money coming in. A 2025 circular bars revenue agencies from collecting state revenue in cash, taxpayers have been able to declare and pay online through the e-Tax platform since January 2023, and 3,000 electronic payment terminals were handed to the Ministry of Finance on 24 July 2026, with no deployment schedule or per-agency allocation stated. Money going out barely moves: almost no adults receive government payments in digital form, against 15% who received a government payment in any form (2023).

Registries

Chad ranks seventh in Africa on the Ibrahim Index's civil registration measure, at 75.0 out of 100 and up 12.5 points over 2014-2023 — a score for the legal and institutional framework rather than for what it produces. Birth registration reached 25.5% of children under five, 50% in urban areas against 21.1% in rural ones, with death and marriage registration almost non-existent (2019).

The civil register runs on text messages: registry offices, hospitals, vaccination centres, municipalities, mobile units, refugee camps and schools transmit records by SMS to ANATS, which validates them and sends them back for issuance. Campaigns have registered over 120,000 children through health facilities and over 180,000 pupils through schools since 2023, with digitisation concentrated on births rather than deaths or marriages (2025), and a national operation with UNICEF launched on 24 July 2026 runs to December through schools nationwide and

household visits in twelve provinces. Five years after the TASDJIL application was introduced, UNICEF and the civil status directorate issued new monthly paper forms for collecting and transmitting civil-status data at a workshop in August 2026.

The other registers stand apart from one another. The Unified Social Registry held 684,500 households in September 2025 but does not use the national biometric identifier as its key, which limits matching (2025). The biometric voter register, 7,388,348 voters as of 2021 and updated across seven southern provinces in 2023, is compiled independently of the national population register. Even civil registration and the biometric population register are not technically integrated although ANATS administers both, and a February 2026 workshop worked on connecting the courts that issue late-registration judgments. There is no national digital cadastre, only pilots (2023); land titles began moving onto the E-Conservation system from 2023 while recording stayed largely on paper; company registration is handled manually (2026); and the taxpayer register is assessed by the IMF as incomplete and not yet reliable (2024). The newest is e-BNFT, which took enrolment of road-freight operators online on 3 August 2026.

Sectoral management information systems

Chad has no civil service human resource management system and no payroll system, so the public wage bill is not administered on one (2025). Money is better served: a commercial financial management system is in use for treasury execution, at central government level only, alongside a commercial public debt management system (2025), while the tax administration runs custom-built software that exchanges data with nothing else (2025). Tax administration sits on SIGTAS, launched in 2015, and the E.Tax platform of the Direction Générale des Impôts, covering personal and business taxes (2026), and Finance Law 2026 makes e-Tax use exclusive and mandatory, requires electronic invoicing and provides for automated data interconnections between the tax administration and specified institutions.

Half of the ten core back-office government systems tracked are in use — financial management, tax, customs, social insurance and debt management — and half are absent. Of the four whose software type is recorded, three are commercial off-the-shelf products and only the tax system is custom-built.

In the line ministries the systems are national at the top and paper at the bottom. The health management information system runs on DHIS2, with almost all health districts reporting into it (2022), while rural clinics record consultations in paper registers and on paper forms that are entered electronically only at district level (2024). The education management information system has run since 2014 and publishes annual yearbooks, but has no unique school codification linking it to other administrative platforms (2025); its functions have been decentralised to 16 of 23 provinces across a system of 12,863 primary schools (2025), where enrolment and attendance are written by hand and pass through inspectorate, district and province before reaching the national StatEduc2 software.

Justice and policing are at pilot stage. An e-Justice case management platform launched in N'Djamena in October 2025 ahead of a planned national roll-out, links litigants, lawyers and judicial staff but exchanges data with no other government system, and the EU-funded, INTERPOL-implemented police information system was still renovating its data collection centre and rolling out fingerprint identification in mid-2025, with the project extended to December 2025.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

There is no national government service portal in Chad, and none of the six capabilities that would go with one, including any means for citizens to take part in designing the services (2025); the country scored 0.1785 on the UN's E-Government Development Index in 2024, 189th of 193. Nor is there any e-participation channel or central feedback and grievance platform (2025), or any electronic government procurement system (2025).

What exists instead is a scatter of single-purpose platforms. The National Employment Promotion Office runs a site where job seekers register, maintain CVs and receive vacancy alerts, and opened a salaried-employment window in June 2025; it links to no other administrative database. Businesses and taxpayers can file and pay through the e-Tax platform, whose use the 2026 finance law makes exclusive and mandatory; road-freight operators can enrol through e-BNFT, launched on 3 August 2026; litigants and lawyers in the capital can use the e-Justice pilot. None of them shares a front door or an identity check: as at 2023 there was no gateway through which a citizen could authenticate with a digital ID, and no government-to-person or government-to-business transactional service.

The ambition outruns the machinery, since Chad has no dedicated digital government institution and nothing coordinating or auditing government technology across ministries (2025). The 2027 budget orientations would nonetheless make e-Visa the sole channel for applying for, paying for and receiving a visa, take business creation online end to end, from filing and fees to identifiers and the delivery of documents, and require public bodies to pay only by electronic transfer to final beneficiaries against standardised electronic invoices from the start of 2027.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

Chad's parliament completed ratification in December 2025 of a change to its telecommunications statute that runs to exactly one article. Ordonnance n°011/PR/2025 of 5 August 2025 amends article 18 of Loi n°013/PR/2014 on the regulation of electronic communications and postal activities, and was ratified by the National Assembly on 22 October 2025 by 105 votes to 31 with 2 abstentions; the Senate followed on 23 December 2025 by 65 votes of 67. The article it reaches is the statute's enforcement machinery: it lets the regulator ARCEP serve an operator with a *mise en demeure* of up to 30 days for breach of national law or of the conditions of its authorisation, or for anticompetitive conduct.

The rest of the framework is a decade old. Law No. 009/PR/2015 on cybersecurity and the fight against cybercrime is the single text carrying the legal basis for cybersecurity, data protection, digital identification, digital payments, digital signatures and e-commerce, alongside Law No. 014/PR/2014, which covers broadband, quality of service, digital identification and digital payments. The 2015 package of five laws gives a broad digital-economy base but establishes no authority for cross-government data sharing and governs no data exchange system. There is no right to information law, and neither supporting access-to-records measure is in place (2025).

Of thirty instruments surveyed across identity, cybersecurity, fintech, e-government, artificial intelligence and connectivity, twenty-one have no Chadian counterpart — among them a digital identity law, an interoperability framework, a national cybersecurity strategy, critical-infrastructure protection, cloud and open data policy, an AI strategy, a startup act, a regulatory sandbox and spectrum policy.

The government's own position is that this will not hold: a 34-member committee with a 45-day deadline was inaugurated on 27 April 2026 to overhaul the digital, telecom and postal legal framework, which it considers outdated relative to the pace of innovation. Where law reaches citizens it is doing repair work: a moratorium signed on 2 February 2026 suspends greffe fees on jugements supplétifs, the court order substituting for a missing birth record, until 2030 — needed under a framework that already makes birth registration universal, free and mandatory.

Strategies, plans and policies

Tchad Connexion 2030, unveiled in 2025, is a US\$1.5 billion plan to digitise and interconnect all public services, sitting alongside the Plan Stratégique de Développement du Numérique et des Postes 2020-2030, and Chad has no institution to run it: no dedicated digital government institution exists, no machinery coordinates or audits government technology across ministries, and nothing about that function is transparent to the public (2025). The standing sector instrument remains the Strategic Plan 2020-2030 for the postal, electronic communication and digital economy sector, published by the communications ministry, which carries broadband, universal access, digital identification, digital payments and e-commerce.

Newer commitments arrive through the budget rather than through strategy. The "zéro cash, zéro papier" mandate sits under the Public Finance Reform Strategy 2022-2027, justified by revenue security, spending control and traceability, and the 2027 orientations restate it with a new start date, with no cost, no phasing and no named implementing agency (August 2026). The national biometric registry is presented by the authorities as an instrument of Tchad Connexion 2030 (March 2026), and the government frames digital regulation as sovereignty, its then-minister for digital economy stating in December 2025 that "in the digital age, a country that does not control its data does not control its destiny".

The administration these plans have to work through is thin and getting thinner. Chad scores 34.8 out of 100 for overall governance in the 2024 Ibrahim Index of African Governance, 47th of 54 African states and 14.5 points below the African average (2023), scoring above that average on only 15 of the index's 96 indicators. Within its best-scoring economic sub-category, Effective Administration — the professionalism and reach of the bureaucracy — fell 3.5 points to 30.8, 47th of 54.

Regional collaboration

The rules governing Chad's mobile money are written regionally, not nationally. Payment institutions are licensed and supervised under the CEMAC framework regulation of 21 December 2018, which replaced 2011 rules confining mobile operators to issuing electronic money, and a licence under it carries bank-grade obligations: FCFA 500 million of fully paid-up capital, reinforced solvency norms, periodic cybersecurity audits, AML/CFT processes and absolute ring-fencing of client balances, in exchange for deposits, withdrawals, account-to-account transfers, cross-border remittances and merchant payments. Chad runs no domestic instant payment system of its own, taking part instead in GIMACPAY, the CEMAC-wide platform operated by GIMAC and owned overwhelmingly by the regional central bank.

Identity crosses the border more easily than data does. CEMAC's Additional Act No. 01/13 of 25 June 2013 abolished visas for all CEMAC nationals, so Chadians travel within the six-country zone on national identity documents that member states must issue as biometric documents to ICAO standards — with no formal digital identity interoperability treaty behind it.

Physically the estate barely crosses the border at all. International capacity reaches Chad through a single route to Cameroon, whose underpinning memorandum ARCEP suspended over clauses judged contrary to national digital sovereignty, and the Trans-Saharan backbone that would open a second path, via Niger to the Mediterranean, was far from complete when the government publicly pressed its contractors in March 2025. Where the state does reach outward it follows the corridor: the e-BNFT transport platform was launched on 3 August 2026 in Douala, before Chadian hauliers, freight forwarders and drivers urged to enrol en masse — registering its transport operators where the trade route puts them rather than on its own territory. N'Djamena hosted a sub-regional ARTAC, ITU and ARCEP workshop on mapping Central Africa's fibre-optic infrastructure in December 2025.

Standards

Chad publishes almost no technical standards of its own. There is no government interoperability framework or data-exchange arrangement, and none of the operational standards — data quality, service availability, legacy-system retirement — are in place or published (2025); there is no electronic government procurement system; and there is no government cloud platform and no policy governing where government data may be hosted. Systems are accordingly specified one at a time.

What shared standards apply come from the region or from the regulator. Chad is one of six CEMAC states covered by the BEAC and GIMAC interoperable QR code standard, issued under Règlement N°02/26/CEMAC/UMAC/CORENOFI of 8 April 2026. ARCEP inaugurated real-time monitoring platforms in June 2026 covering traffic, spectrum, quality of service and VSAT, giving it a measurement of operator performance that is not the operators'. ADETIC, ANSICE and TECHSO-GROUP signed a tripartite agreement on 5 February 2026 to audit and certify the National Data Centre against critical-infrastructure security standards, the first certification of a state facility on the record.

Data protection

Chad's newest data law regulates the state's use of biometrics rather than citizens' exposure to it. The National Assembly adopted on 10 April 2026, by 138 votes to 1, a law governing the collection, processing, retention, use and destruction of biometric data exclusively within judicial and judicial-police procedures — a text about police and prosecutors rather than a general protection for personal data.

The general regime is Act No. 007/PR/2015 of 10 February 2015, implemented by Decree No. 075/PR/2019, which governs the collection, processing, storage and transmission of personal data, including the biometric and identity data processed under the national ID system. It sits with ANSICE, created under Act No. 006/PR/2015 and operational since 2020, with powers to investigate complaints, authorise cross-border transfers and sanction violations — a body whose mandate the Senate ratified an ordinance to widen on 13 March 2026, from cybersecurity to personal-data protection, electronic-transaction security, cybercrime, protection of the national information

space and the regulation of video-surveillance and drones. The World Bank's assessment is that the personal data protection framework is not yet fully applied in practice, with no dedicated, publicly documented data-sharing framework for the national ID system (2024).

Two gaps are structural. No statutory duty obliges any data controller to notify users, regulators or the authority of a breach or unauthorised access, though breaches of the Act carry one to five years' imprisonment and fines of XAF 1-10 million, and the general consumer protection law, No. 005/PR/2015, carries no payment-specific rules on error resolution, chargebacks or e-money disputes. Meanwhile identification duties keep widening: SIM registration against a national ID card or passport is compulsory, operators must maintain customer identification databases and give the government access to them, and an arrêt of August 2025 requires every Starlink user — individual, company or public institution — to be formally identified with ARCEP or a licensed operator, supplying identity, address, legal references and the serial numbers of modems, routers and antennas.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Chad's media regulator has stopped licensing online newspapers. HAMA suspended examination of applications to create online newspapers "jusqu'à nouvel ordre" (August 2026), presenting the freeze as an application of its 2026-2028 strategic plan and its axis of "assainir le milieu professionnel", after denouncing a proliferation of pages on social networks passing themselves off as online media and carrying false or defamatory content. The freeze carries no end date, no published criteria for resumption and no stated treatment of applications already filed, and the promised study of new governance arrangements, to be run with all stakeholders, has no published consultation route or submission channel. The sector association AMET, whose president Bello Bakary Mana calls professional online media "a lever for democracy and citizen participation", welcomed the action against fake pages while drawing the press-freedom line the communiqué did not.

The formal channels are narrow. There is no government e-participation platform and none of the five further participation mechanisms (2025), and Participation is Chad's second worst-scoring IIAG sub-category at 15.4 out of 100, 48th of 54, and its steepest decline, 13.1 points lost over 2014-2023, driven by Civil Society Space falling 24.8 points to 11.6 (2023); Accountability and Transparency scores worse still, 13.6 and 50th of 54. One measure moved the other way: Deliberative and Participatory Governance, which tracks whether the state consults before deciding, rose 5.5 points to 30.1.

Argument therefore lands in the chamber. Deputies used the October 2025 telecom ratification debate to raise monopoly, licence sales, corruption and non-respect of operators' cahiers des charges, and in April 2026 warned that inappropriate use of biometric data could harm citizens' integrity and privacy — the law passing regardless. The Economic, Social, Cultural and Environmental Council gave its 6 August 2026 session to the digital economy and artificial intelligence, questioning the former digital economy minister on data protection, cybersecurity and AI governance. One right of audience predates all this: under the 2014 telecommunications law, standing to trigger enforcement against an operator extends beyond the regulator to professional bodies, user associations and affected persons, and ARCEP may publish the notice and its lifting.

Inclusion

Digital divides

The sharpest line in Chad falls before any device is switched on: [mains electricity is an urban service, reaching a minority of town dwellers and almost none of the rural population](#) (2023). The digital effort built on top of it repeats the shape — [it is concentrated in N'Djamena, with sharp urban-rural disparities in internet access and digital literacy gaps among public servants and citizens alike](#) (2024), and the rural coverage promised under Tchad Connexion 2030 has not yet been delivered. The same line runs through documentation, where [birth registration is markedly more complete in towns than in the countryside](#) (2019).

Underneath the geography sits a device and income divide that the connection figures hide. [Smartphone ownership among Chadian adults is among the lowest in sub-Saharan Africa](#) (2024), and [active SIM connections run at several times the share of people who actually use the internet](#) (October 2025), so a mobile market that looks broad is thin at the point where it matters. [The Ibrahim Index's combined measure of internet use, computer access and affordability puts Chad near the bottom of the continent and among the worst-scoring indicators in the whole index](#) (2023), and the same profile shows [education participation and outcomes among Africa's weakest](#) (2023), which bounds who can use a text interface at all.

The gender line is the one nobody has measured: [GSMA's 2025 report carries a 29% mobile internet gender gap for sub-Saharan Africa as a whole and no country-level estimate for Chad](#) (2024).

Displacement and movement add divides of their own. [Refugee-hosting areas in eastern Chad have very little 4G coverage, with handset cost and literacy limiting use of mobile services further](#) (2025). Pastoral populations sit outside routine systems by construction: [the third population census runs the enumeration of herders and nomads through a dedicated national coordination role](#) rather than through its ordinary field structure.

Access to services

[Lac province was cut off from the internet from 28 October 2024 for more than three months](#), a shutdown attributed to security grounds that Internet Society Chad protested in February 2025 as isolating thousands of people from communication, education and the economy. Where the state's own channels are concerned there is little to cut off: [Chad has no national government service portal, and no tax, social protection or jobs portal either](#) (2025), so obtaining a service means presenting yourself at an office and [government payments almost never reach people in digital form](#) (2023).

The document everything starts from is the one most often missing: [829,000 pupils were attending school with no paper attesting their legal existence](#) (2024). The obstacles are prosaic — [distance from civil-status centres, cost, and simple lack of information](#) — and the remedies are correspondingly analogue: [the court fee for the jugement supplétif that substitutes for a missing birth record has been suspended](#) (February 2026), and a [registration operation launched with UNICEF works through schools and household visits](#) (July 2026). Cost bites at the next step too, since [the national identity card is a paid service](#) (2024) and [biometric enrolment does not begin until around age twelve](#), so a registered child holds no credential.

For refugees the barrier has been recognition rather than paper. The biometric IDs now issued replace CNARR and UNHCR credentials that local authorities, banks and service providers often did not accept, and a World Bank-funded pilot with CNARR, UNHCR and Idemia had registered refugees on SIGPTS and issued thousands of cards by May 2025. ANATS has since taken delivery of biometric enrolment equipment from UNHCR for the same push (March 2026), and UNHCR opened a digital learning centre at the Abéché one-stop shop in February 2025, funded by Italy, offering online skills training to refugee and host-community youth.

Against the continent, the improvement is real and the level is not: [Equal Access to Public Services](#), which measures whether provision reaches all social groups and regions evenly, rose 13.1 points over 2014-2023 to 25.5 out of 100, 42nd of 54 (2023).

Technology

AI

Chad's artificial-intelligence governance sits inside its cybersecurity agency: the [reform of ANSICE approved in March 2026](#) gave the agency a mandate carrying provisions on social media, digital services and artificial-intelligence systems. Nothing is running behind it — [no artificial intelligence or advanced analytics is in use in any government data-exchange or interoperability system](#), and basic interoperability between ministries has not been achieved (2024), so there are no data-quality, fraud-detection or predictive applications to govern. The [Economic, Social, Cultural and Environmental Council](#) took up the digital economy and artificial intelligence at its session of 6 August 2026, questioning a former minister on data protection, cybersecurity and AI governance ahead of its recommendations to government.

Chad has no artificial-intelligence strategy and no artificial-intelligence law.

ICT Industry

Chad's business and labour environment scored [31.9 out of 100 in the Ibrahim Index](#), 47th of 54 African countries (2023), flat across the decade, with the business and competition regulations component down 13.3 points to 43.3 — the terms on which a technology firm would register and operate got worse, not better. There is [no startup or innovation law](#), and [no government financing or SME support for technology firms](#) (2025). Commercial activity amounts to [a few dozen registered companies, concentrated in fintech, e-commerce and digital services](#) (2025), and Chad has [run no business or establishment survey in the ten years to 2023](#), so the firm sector has never been enumerated.

The state's own systems are bought in rather than built.

Innovation ecosystem

Chad is [not among the 133 economies ranked in the WIPO Global Innovation Index 2024](#), absent from the global innovation and entrepreneurship indexes for want of the data needed to place it. Its incubator base is [two hubs, both in N'Djamena — Wenaklabs, the first, founded in 2014, and Chad Innovation, running since 2018 and affiliated to the pan-African AfriLabs network](#) — with nothing documented outside the capital; Wenaklabs hosts the [Francophonie's D-CLIC programme, launched in April 2026 as Makers Tchad](#). Ventures do come out of this and reach users:

Telemedan, founded by the Chadian entrepreneur Abakar Mahamat, delivers healthcare to remote parts of the country through solar-powered telemedicine kiosks and is backed by the Ministry of Health and the World Bank (2025), and Konoom, an N'Djamena payments startup launched in 2025, holds a COBAC licence for its wallet. Of the companies trackers record, a minority have raised venture or private-equity money, in fintech, e-commerce and digital services (2025). Behind them sits no public-sector innovation programme or strategy (2025).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

A Chadian government mission spent nine days in Washington, from 23 to 31 May 2026, meeting the State and Commerce Departments and the firms Starlink, InterSystems, Cybastion, Vertiv and 19Labs across connectivity, cybersecurity and digital health.

Only one of those firms sells into Chad today. Starlink was licensed to operate in November 2024 and went commercially live on 4 July 2025, which puts the American footprint in front of retail subscribers rather than inside a state contract.

The state-to-state side is thinner and sits in cybersecurity. ANSICE and the United States Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency held a videoconference in January 2025 covering cyber-threat monitoring, engineer capacity, incident response and critical-infrastructure protection, following Chad's participation in the 2024 Counter-Ransomware Initiative summit. That contact and the Washington round sixteen months later put American agencies alongside Chad's cyber regulator without putting an American firm inside the state's own build.

China activities

China's ambassador to Chad, Wang Xining, put the dependency question himself in January 2025, asking how Chad would take ownership of the National Data Centre building and its machines in the absence of Chinese technicians. The building was still not handed over more than a year later: it had passed provisional technical reception and was undergoing final security certification coordinated by ADETIC and ANSICE ahead of formal launch (2026).

The position underneath that question is a single vendor holding the whole build. Huawei Technologies is the contractor for the National Data Centre, and the same firm is the engineering, procurement and construction contractor for the wider programme, which pairs the data centre with a national fibre backbone running south to east and a loop around N'Djamena serving the capital's mobile sites. The lending and the contracting are the same relationship seen twice: a China Eximbank concessional loan and a separate RMB 170 million Chinese government grant (2019), whose proceeds were both expected to finance one engineering, procurement and construction contract with Huawei. The loan is collateralised against a minimum cash balance held in an escrow account, which gives the lender a claim that does not depend on the network being finished. The framework agreement behind it was signed on 26 June 2019 and ratified on 20 August 2019.

Chinese state finance accounts for the larger part of all digital-sector money on record for Chad, ahead of the World Bank, the African Development Bank and the ITU combined.

The same vendor is positioned for the next programme as well: the government is stepping up the rollout of Tchad Connexion 2030, its plan for rural coverage, in talks with Huawei.

EU activities

The deepest European position in Chad is in policing data. The EU-funded, INTERPOL-implemented Chad Police Information System was still completing the renovation of its Data Collection and Registration Centre and rolling out an automated fingerprint identification system as of mid-2025, with the project extended to December 2025 — European money paying for the country's criminal biometric capability, built by an outside implementer rather than by the police themselves.

The second position is a vendor one, in identity. Idemia supplies the biometrics behind the refugee identity system: a World Bank-funded pilot run with CNARR, UNHCR and Idemia registered refugees and had issued them biometric IDs in the thousands by May 2025, and Chad was still issuing refugee cards on Idemia technology in March 2026, by which point ANATS had also received biometric enrolment equipment from UNHCR for its inclusive-identification push.

Everything else European is training, and it is small and recent. The Organisation internationale de la Francophonie launched its D-CLIC programme in Chad in April 2026 as "Makers Tchad – Jeunesse et innovation pour l'emploi", hosted at the N'Djamena innovation hub Wenaklabs, and UNHCR inaugurated an Italian-funded digital learning centre at the Abéché one-stop-shop in February 2025, offering online skills training to refugee and host-community young people in eastern Chad.

India activities

Indian engagement with Chad's digital sector has not progressed past talks. Chad and India discussed digital cooperation in February 2025, with training in artificial intelligence among the areas Chad sought, and the same discussions covered support for ENASTIC, the national ICT training school, and the establishment of a postal bank. India held no operating, financing or vendor position in Chad's digital estate as at August 2026.

Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf state, sovereign fund, operator or vendor held a recorded position in Chad's digital infrastructure, identity systems or telecommunications market as at August 2026.

Capacity

Literacy

Chad's schooling floor is among the lowest on the continent and has fallen rather than risen: education enrolment scored 21.2 out of 100 in 2023, 48th of 54 African countries and 1.2 points below its level a decade earlier, with completion at 14.4 and equality in education at 22.3. Education is nonetheless one of the country's more improved governance sub-categories over 2014 to 2023, though it still ranked 49th of 54 in 2023. This is the pool from which the users and the operators of any digital system in Chad have to be drawn.

Above that floor, digital literacy gaps run through both the public service and the citizenry, with the transformation effort concentrated in N'Djamena (2024), and no government programme reaches into schools or the wider population to close them (2025). The systems that do run on schools are administrative rather than instructional: the education management information system has been in place since 2014 and publishes annual yearbooks, but has no unique school codification linking it to other platforms, and its functions have been decentralised to two-thirds of the provinces (2025) without changing what the schools themselves record on paper. A large share of pupils attend school with no document attesting their legal existence at all (2024).

The one national plan that names literacy places it in the future: the payment-terminal programme running under Tchad Connexion 2030 is to be followed by digital and financial literacy work, public digital centres and rural connectivity (July 2026).

Training and skills

Chad has no digital skills programme for its public servants — no strategy, no programme, and no reach into schools or the wider citizenry (2025). What training exists is run and paid for by outside bodies.

The Organisation internationale de la Francophonie launched its D-CLIC programme in Chad in April 2026 as "Makers Tchad — Jeunesse et innovation pour l'emploi", hosted at the N'Djamena innovation hub Wenaklabs, teaching fabrication and connected-device skills including CNC machining and the internet of things. In the east, UNHCR inaugurated a digital learning centre at the Abéché one-stop shop in February 2025, funded by Italy, for refugee and host-community young people. Both of the country's identifiable technology hubs sit in the capital, so provision outside N'Djamena depends on whichever agency chooses to place a centre there.

At least three separate donor-funded programmes carry the country's digital skills training — the OIF's Makers Tchad, the PDMFI financial-inclusion training and UNHCR's Abéché learning centre — and the two that publish participant numbers come to roughly 270 trainees (2026).

Government's own training runs to single events. The ministry of higher education, research and vocational training trained its agents on the StatEduc application in July 2026, covering questionnaire configuration, deployment of data-entry masks, consistency checking and the interpretation of indicators, framed as planning infrastructure for the higher-education and vocational sector. The World Bank's digital transformation project, running to 2029, carries capacity building alongside its infrastructure and government systems components. The formal pipeline behind all of this is narrow: tertiary ICT education is confined to a small number of programmes at the Université de N'Djamena, whose Faculté des Sciences Exactes et Appliquées offers Licence and Master's degrees in computer science (2026).

Research institutions

Knowledge about Chad's digital systems is produced almost entirely outside the country: the Université de N'Djamena is the only institution with computer science degree programmes, and its research output is minimal (2026).

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

Outside N'Djamena the routine administrative record is still made on paper, and most of what is captured digitally is captured because a donor put a device in someone's hand: rural primary schools [complete enrolment and attendance returns by hand](#), the forms passing up through zone inspectorate, district and province before anything is keyed into the national schools statistics software (2025), and rural clinics [keep consultations in paper registers](#) that are entered electronically only at district level (2024). A [pilot of digital school data collection in two provinces](#) was never taken national, and the wider digital effort remains [concentrated in the capital](#), with Tchad Connexion 2030 meant to extend rural coverage and not yet implemented (2024).

The one national system built for reach runs on text messages: civil registry offices, hospitals, vaccination centres, municipalities, mobile units, refugee camps and schools [pass registration data to ANATS by SMS](#), which validates it and returns it for issuance. The child registration operation under way in July 2026 [equips teams recruited from within the communities with smartphones](#), working household to household with the data fed into the national biometric register. Health capture has moved the same way in places: a [tablet-based consultation record piloted in southern Chad](#) is being extended into southern health districts, and [solar-powered telemedicine kiosks](#) reach remote areas (2025). Each is a programme with an owner outside the administration rather than a service the state itself runs.

The constraints sit underneath all of it: [rural electricity access is close to nil](#) against a substantial urban rate (2023), [4G coverage stops well short of the population](#) and use far short of coverage (2023), and [Lac province spent months without any internet at all](#) after October 2024. Rural policy scores better than that record suggests — [Rural Economy Support is among Chad's ten most improved governance indicators](#), up 23.7 points over 2014-2023 to 53.4 out of 100, while Rural Land & Water Access fell 11.4 points to 40.6 (2023) — but that is a scoring of policy and institutions, not of what gets recorded at the point it happens.

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The digital state stops at the centre: [no sub-national body takes part in any government data-exchange framework, and most government offices have neither broadband nor any means of exchanging data](#) (2024), while the financial management system covering treasury execution [runs at central government level only](#) (2025). Budget orientations published in August 2026 propose [generalising SIGFIP to local authorities, public establishments, projects and missions abroad](#) for real-time monitoring of budget execution, with no rollout date attached.

What exists below the national level is programme-specific, and mostly someone else's programme. Education has the widest reach, with management information functions [decentralised to two-thirds of the provinces](#) and the remainder to follow (2025), though that concerns compiling and using data at province level rather than what the schools themselves record. Civil status is where local administration is most exposed: [ANATS, the Organisation Internationale de la Francophonie and N'Djamena city hall deepened civil-registry interoperability in April 2026](#), and a [one-stop registration office opened at Bol in Lake province in November 2023](#), putting registration alongside the health facilities that notify births.

The measure of how far that has travelled is what was handed to officials at Sarh on 7-8 August 2026: [new monthly paper forms for collecting and transmitting civil-status data](#), five years after the TASDJIL application was introduced. Registration coverage differs sharply between [neighbouring southern provinces under the same statute, the same fee waiver and the same national campaign](#) (August 2026). Where the centre does reach into the provinces it tends to go around the local administration rather than through it: the July 2026 registration campaign [associates administrative and traditional authorities with the enrolment to vouch for its reliability](#) while the enrolment itself is run by ANATS teams.

Data

National statistics

A decree of 20 July 2026 [extended the main enumeration of Chad's third population and housing census to 6 August](#), past the window an earlier decree had fixed in May, giving as its reason the need to reorganise teams and run sweeps across the national territory — the government recording on the instrument itself that field coverage was incomplete at the original deadline. [RGPH-3 ran through 2026](#), with a [dedicated national coordination for enumerating herders and nomadic populations](#).

The production system beneath it is weakest where it collects: Chad's [weakest pillars in the World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators](#) are data sources and data infrastructure, both in the 20-49% band (2023), against 70-89% for data use and data products. In the ten years to 2023 it ran household, agricultural and health surveys but no labour force survey and no business or establishment survey, and over twenty years a population census but no agricultural and no business census, so employment and the firm sector have no enumerated base.

Capacity of the Statistical System is among Chad's ten most improved Ibrahim Index indicators, up 14.0 points over 2014-2023 to 42.7 out of 100 and 35th of 54. INSEED disseminates survey and census data through its own portal while administrative data held by sector ministries — education, health, justice, civil registration and telecommunications among them — remains poorly harmonised and outside any shared government data exchange, and the higher-education ministry configures and runs its own StatEduc questionnaires with no published route into the national statistics.

Civil registration yields the most-quoted numbers and the least complete: [48.33 per cent of newborns were registered inside the three-month legal deadline \(2024\)](#) and [about 2.9 million children under five were undeclared that year](#), a count standing in for a coverage rate that still rests on a [2019 household survey](#). The connectivity figures are modelled, not counted: the [2025 DataReportal](#) edition puts internet adoption at 13.2%, down from 22.5% a year earlier, while recording users up over the year and the adoption rate unchanged. The World Bank operation funding INSEED's collection and dissemination capacity closed in 2022.

Open data

Disclosure of Public Records is Chad's seventh most improved Ibrahim Index indicator, up 17.4 points over 2014-2023 to 35.6 out of 100 and 20th of 54, while Accessibility of Public Records — whether a citizen can obtain those records in practice — rose 1.9 points to 16.5 and 42nd of 54. More is put out; almost none of it is more reachable.

Chad has no government open data portal, and none of the supporting measures such as catalogue coverage and update frequency are recorded (2025). There is no data governance body and no data governance strategy, and nothing about how government systems handle data is published. No public dashboard, data-sharing agreement or annual report covers the operation of government data systems: the back-office systems that do exist — SIGFiP, the eTax application and ASYCUDA World for customs — are internal to individual ministries, and there is no right to information law by which anyone could compel disclosure.

What is published, the Open Data Inventory scores poorly. Chad's strongest categories in the 2024 inventory are agriculture and health facilities at 7 out of 10, government finance and price statistics at 6.5, and education facilities and poverty at 6 — a weak best. Population and vital statistics score 5, with education outcomes, gender, reproductive health and crime statistics all at 4.5, which matters directly for registry work that needs demographic denominators to know what coverage it has reached. Economic statistics are weaker still: international trade and labour at 3.5, balance of payments and national accounts at 4, money and banking at 5. Three of the 23 categories assessed score zero — energy, pollution, and the digital and communications category itself, so the sector this report describes publishes no open national data about itself.

Use of satellite data

Chad's regulator ARCEP signed a space cooperation memorandum with Azerbaijan's Azercosmos in January 2026 covering satellite connectivity and remote sensing for areas fibre does not reach — a memorandum rather than a funded deployment, and the only arrangement on the books that treats Earth observation as something the state might use rather than only as a way to carry traffic.

The rest is connectivity. Starlink's operating licence was approved in November 2024 and confirmed by the Ministry of Telecommunications in March 2025, and the service went commercially live on 4 July 2025 with a published tariff grid. It runs on a multiservice ISP licence rather than a mobile-operator licence, granted on application after a favourable ARCEP technical opinion and without a public tender, as the telecommunications minister told the National Assembly on 22 October 2025.

Imagery has been used in land administration only in trials: donor-supported pilots with Kadaster International, Esri and Trimble tested fit-for-purpose cadastral mapping in selected areas, and no operational national digital cadastre followed.

Finance

New investments

Chinese state finance accounts for roughly three-fifths of the money committed to Chad's digital estate — about USD 243 million of the USD 410 million on record (2026), against USD 139 million from the World Bank across three projects and USD 27 million from the African Development Bank across two. Eight commitments make up that record, running from 2017 to 2029. About USD 349 million is in active implementation (2026), USD 48 million has closed, and USD 13 million sits at identification stage, unapproved. Connectivity takes the bulk of it; most of the money is concessional, but the largest single line is debt.

That concentration is one project: China Eximbank's [government concessional loan for the ICT Modernization Project](#), RMB 1.316 billion or CFA 111.4 billion — about USD 189 million at signature — signed on 26 June 2019 and approved unanimously by Parliament on 30 April 2020. It runs 20 years at 2 per cent with a five-year grace period, collateralised against a minimum cash balance in an escrow account. A separate RMB 170 million Chinese grant, about USD 28 million, followed in 2019, both financing one engineering and construction contract with Huawei. The project was originally to complete on 31 October 2021.

The [World Bank's Chad Digital Transformation Project](#) is an SDR 69.5 million IDA grant, about USD 92 million, running 2024 to 2029 across infrastructure, digital government and financial services. Two earlier operations have closed: a [USD 12 million statistical development project](#) (2017 to 2022) and a [USD 35 million revenue-administration digitalisation project](#) (2018 to 2023).

African Development Bank money is moving slowly: its [microfinance and digital financial services project for women and young entrepreneurs](#) opened with a UA 9.7 million Transition Support Facility grant in December 2021, since topped up to commitments of XDR 10,173,150.53, about USD 14 million, but disbursements had reached only XDR 2,062,292.94 across fourteen transactions by June 2026. A [further grant to modernise public administration](#) was at identification stage (July 2026), and the [ITU's Central African ICT benchmarking project](#), which named Chad among eight countries, closed in 2023.

MoUs and other agreements

The most consequential agreement of the past year is one that is not in force: the regulator ARCEP suspended the [April 2025 memorandum underpinning the N'Djamena–Mberé fibre link to Cameroon](#) over clauses judged contrary to national digital sovereignty, and by February 2026 the government was pressing Sotel Tchad and Airtel to fast-track a revised text.

Little else that has been signed carries money or a timetable. [ANATS and the International Organization for Migration signed a memorandum in May 2026](#) on secure identity for vulnerable populations and migrants, building on the SIGPTS system. ARCEP signed a [space cooperation memorandum with Azerbaijan's Azercosmos in January 2026](#) covering satellite connectivity and remote sensing for areas fibre does not reach, and an [Azerbaijani ICT delegation visited ADETIC the following month](#) to discuss data centres and digital infrastructure. The [International Finance Corporation's partnership with the Chadian fintech Cash](#), announced in March 2026, is an intention to build an interoperable payments platform connecting banks and mobile money operators rather than a platform. A [government mission to Washington from 23 to 31 May 2026](#) met the State and Commerce Departments and the firms Starlink, InterSystems, Cybastion, Vertiv and 19Labs across connectivity, cybersecurity and digital health.

The agreement that plainly binds is the oldest of them: Chad and China signed a [preferential loan framework agreement for the ICT Modernization Project on 26 June 2019](#), between the Chinese Ambassador, Li Jinjin, and Chad's Minister of Economy and Development Planning, Issa Dubrani, with the concessional loan agreement signed the same day.

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